

THE STRUCTURE OF MATHEMATICAL REALITY

Phase II — Chapter 6

The Unreasonable Effectiveness Problem

Parallel Reading

Self-Study Curriculum

Parallel Reading: Read these two papers in order, they are short, accessible, and form a dialogue:

1. Eugene Wigner, “The Unreasonable Effectiveness of Mathematics in the Natural Sciences” (1960). ~15 pages. Freely available online.
2. Richard Hamming, “The Unreasonable Effectiveness of Mathematics” (1980). ~10 pages. Freely available online.

Then read: PCM, sections VIII.1 (“The Art of Problem Solving”) and VIII.5 (“Mathematics: An Experimental Science”).